

84 Question words with “-ever”

Adding “-ever” to question words changes their meaning. These words can be adverbs or determiners in their own clauses, or they can join two clauses together.

See also:

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84.1 QUESTION WORDS WITH “-EVER”

Words ending “-ever” are most commonly used to mean “it doesn’t matter what,” “I don’t know,” or to say that the options are unrestricted. They can be used as subjects and objects.



I’m still going to the game, **whatever** the weather’s like.

[It doesn’t matter what the weather is like. I’m still going.]



We can take a taxi or walk, **whichever** you prefer.

[It doesn’t matter to me which you choose, taxi or walking.]

Here, “whichever” is an object.



Whoever invented the umbrella was a very clever person.

[I don’t know who invented the umbrella, but they were very clever.]

Here, “whoever” is a subject.



We’ll reschedule for **whenever** the sun comes out next.

[I don’t know when it will be, but we’ll reschedule for the next time it’s sunny.]



I always check the forecast for **wherever** I’m going to be.

[I check the forecast for the place I am going to be, no matter where it is.]



I’m sure you’ll arrive on time, **however** you decide to travel.

[No matter which mode of transportation you choose, I’m sure you’ll be on time.]